

Chronicle

Design System — tokens, color, components, responsive & accessibility plan

1. Styling Approach & Tokens

Stack: Tailwind CSS (utility classes for layout/spacing) layered on top of CSS custom properties for the token values themselves, so the token layer stays framework-independent and Tailwind's `theme.extend` just reads from the same variables. React components consume tokens via Tailwind classes (e.g. `bg-surface`, `text-accent-gold`), never hard-coded hex values.

Token	CSS variable	Value	Used for
color.bg.deep	--color-bg-deep	#0B1026	App background, header bars
color.surface	--color-surface	#1B2340	Cards, tiles, panels
color.accent.ice	--color-accent-ice	#9FD8FF	Primary interactive (links, active tab)
color.accent.gold	--color-accent-gold	#D9B36C	Secondary accent, category dividers, arrows
color.text.primary	--color-text-primary	#F2F4FA	Body text, headings on dark surfaces
color.text.muted	--color-text-muted	#A9B2CC	Preview snippets, metadata, timestamps
space.xs / sm / md / lg / xl	--space-1.5	4 / 8 / 16 / 24 / 40px	Consistent spacing scale (4px base unit)
radius.card	--radius-card	12px	Tiles, panels, modals

font.family	--font-family-base	Inter (UI), Cormorant Garamond (headings/titles)	Body vs. codex-style display type
type.scale	--font-size-1.6	12 / 14 / 16 / 20 / 24 / 32px	Modular type scale, 1.25 ratio

2. Color & Contrast

There will be five roles, each contrast-checked against the background(s) it actually appears on using the WCAG 2.1 relative-luminance formula. Note: both swatches for the background and surface were made into a gradient background.

Swatch	Role	Hex	Checked against	Ratio
	Background (gradient) (deep)	<i>#0B1026</i>	n/a — base surface	—
	Surface (cards/tiles)	<i>#1B2340</i>	on Background	n/a (non-text)
	Primary accent / links	<i>#9FD8FF</i>	on Background #0B1026	12.31:1
	Secondary accent / gold	<i>#D9B36C</i>	on Surface #1B2340	7.80:1
	Text — primary	<i>#F2F4FA</i>	on Background #0B1026	17.11:1
	Text — muted	<i>#A9B2CC</i>	on Surface #1B2340	7.29:1

3. Reusable Components

Pulled directly from the Part 2 wireframes' component tree; each is listed once with its level and props, even though several appear on multiple screens.

Component	Level	Props	Appears on
Icon	atom	name, size, color	everywhere
Label	atom	text, variant (heading/body/muted)	everywhere
Button	atom	label, icon?, variant (primary/ghost), onPress	Home, Composer, Settings
ColorSwatch	atom	hex, selected: bool, onSelect	Composer, Settings
Tag	atom	text, onRemove?	Entry Viewer/Editor
TextInput	atom	value, placeholder, multiline: bool, onChange	Composer, Entry Editor
CategoryTile	molecule	icon, title, accentColor, segmentCount, onPress, onLongPress(edit)	Home
SegmentListItem	molecule	title, previewText, tag?, onPress	Category Branch View, Entry Desktop preview pane
DisplayModeToggle	molecule	value: bullet list paragraph, onChange	Entry Viewer/Editor, Settings (as default picker)

Component	Level	Props	Appears on
Breadcrumb	molecule	path: {label, onPress}[]	NavHeader on Branch, Entry, Composer
NavHeader	organism	breadcrumb, actions: Icon[]	all 5 screens — one component, repeated, not redrawn
CategoryGrid	organism	categories[], columns (responsive), onTileOpen, onAddNew	Home
SegmentList	organism	segments[], onSelect, onAddNew	Category Branch View
EntryEditorPanel	organism	blocks[], displayMode, editing: bool, tags[], onSave	Entry Viewer/Editor

4. Responsive & Accessibility Plan

Breakpoints

Name	Width	Layout change
mobile	< 640px	CategoryGrid: 2 columns. Branch View: single-pane list only (no preview pane). Entry Editor: display-mode switch compact under header.
tablet	640–1023px	CategoryGrid: 3 columns. Branch View: still single-pane (not enough width for a comfortable two-pane split).
desktop	≥ 1024px	CategoryGrid: 4 columns + inline search. Branch View: two-pane master/detail. Entry reading column capped at ~720px, centered.

Accessibility Checklist

Item	How it's addressed
Color contrast	All text/background role pairs verified $\geq 4.5:1$; accent colors never used as the sole carrier of meaning.
Keyboard navigation	CategoryGrid, SegmentList, and DisplayModeToggle are all tab-reachable and arrow-key navigable; Composer modal traps focus and returns it to the triggering element on close.
Focus states	A visible 2px accent-ice focus ring token (<code>--focus-ring</code>) is applied to every interactive atom, distinct from hover state.
Icon-only controls	Every icon-only Button (settings gear, back chevron, add-new) ships an aria-label; CategoryTile icons are decorative and paired with a visible text Label so meaning never depends on the icon alone.
Screen reader structure	NavHeader breadcrumb uses a semantic nav/ol list; EntryEditorPanel content uses real heading levels per bullet sub-heading rather than styled div text.
Reduced motion	Tile-open and branch-expand animations respect preferred-reduced-motion and fall back to an instant cross-fade.
Touch targets	All tappable atoms (Button, CategoryTile, SegmentListItem) enforce a 44×44px minimum hit area at the mobile breakpoint, even where the visible label is smaller.